different parts of the Indian subcontinent, and to a lesser extent, the outside world.

Medieval Migrations: From Mlecchas to Firangis

In the medieval period, from roughly the 13th century CE to the early 18th century CE, there were three major changes that increased the overall spatial mobility. First, at the global level, there was an increase in people's mobility and widening of horizons in what has been referred to as the Arid Zone which comprised much of east, central and west Asia and Eastern Europe, with the successful march of pastoral nomads over relatively more sedentary peasant-based societies.[48] These mass migrations were linked with warfare across the region and made India's north-west an important site of battles among competing outside rulers for supremacy over the subcontinent. Many people entered India as refugees from central Asia fleeing Mongol invasions. Even the arid zones within India, such as the Deccan, were affected. In general, a massive military labour market was created consisting of the Rajputs, Marathas, and many other groups including armed peasants, with lasting legacies for spatial mobility.[49] Some evidence of the scale can be understood from the fact that nearly 4,00,000 cavalry and over 4 million infantry served in the Mughal Empire under Akbar in the late 16th century, when the total size of his empire was pegged at over a 100 million.[50]

Closely related with these developments was the mass migration of hundreds of thousands of animals—horses, oxen, sheep, goats and dromedaries or Arabian camels—that carried humans and goods in large caravans mostly plied by the *Banjaras*.[51] The success of military campaigns in India depended in large part in securing access to grains and other supplies from the Banjaras. Similarly, Afghan traders and warriors positioned themselves in Rayalaseema, a semi-arid zone of south India, in the 17th and 18th centuries to control the supply lines of mercenaries and horses from the north, and also the Deccan pilgrimage route to Tirupati.